PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Monday, October 20, 2025

Policy Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Policy Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center - Board Auditorium, 501 N. Dixon St, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members:
Board Vice-Chair Michelle DePass (Committee Chair); Directors Engelsman and Chase-Miller.

Non-Committee Board Members:
Chair Eddie Wang and Director Virginia La Forte

Other Attendees:
Liz Large – Contracted Legal Counsel
Kara Bradshaw – Confidential Executive Assistant, Board Clerk
Emily Courtnage – Director of Purchasing and Contracting
Kristen Weiler – Risk Management Associate

Call to Order / Introductions

The meeting was called to order at 4:33 pm by Committee Chair Michelle DePass.

Public Comment

Time: 4:35 pm

- Yuki Sakai: Highlighted the benefits of language residency programs.
- Mina Hsu: Student. In support for any student who would like to go on an international field trip.
- Kelli George: In support of revising Field Trips, Foreign Travel, and Other Off-Campus Activities Policy 6.50.010-P, noting that the complaint that was brought up in 2016 has not been brought up again.
- Kojo Hakam: Shared the benefits of the dual language residencies program.
- Angela Bonilla: In opposition to the proposed changes in the Purchasing and Contracting Rules / Policy.

Field Trips, Foreign Travel, and Other Off-Campus Activities Policy 6.50.010-P

Time: 4:54 pm

Board Chair Wang explained that the proposed policy revisions are intended to align with policy best practices by reducing prescriptiveness, administrative burden, and address equity concerns. Committee members discussed whether to delay the conversation on the policy revisions due to incomplete materials, the purpose of the policy and what the revisions are intended to address, and how the original policy requirements have contributed to process challenges. The committee ultimately agreed to move the policy to the full Board for consideration, with one member indicating an intent to abstain due to insufficient materials. A request was made to update the policy comparison document included in the materials to reflect the most recent policy proposal.

Purchasing and Contracting Rules / Policy

Time: 5:35 pm

Staff: Emily Courtnage – Senior Legal Counsel

Staff provided an overview of the proposed changes to the Purchasing and Contracting Rules, which include increasing the thresholds for Board approval, in order to reduce administrative burden, and better align with inflation and practices used by similarly sized public agencies. Board members discussed transparency and community trust, appropriate levels of Board oversight versus operational management, comparisons to other large districts, and options for maintaining visibility into higher-value contracts through alternative reporting methods.

The committee moved the policy to the full Board for further consideration.

Districtwide Advocacy and Fundraising 7.10.020-P (Discussion Only)

Time: 6:03 pm

Board members discussed the Districtwide Advocacy and Fundraising Policy 7.10.020-P at the request of Director Engelsman, who outlined her concerns. The committee discussed the policy, including broader commentary on school funding, noting that reliance on fundraising reflects ongoing underfunding of education at the state level and places communities in competition for limited resources.

Liability of Employees of the District Policy 5.50.020-P

Time: 6:12 pm

There was no discussion. The proposed policy was moved to the full board for consideration.

Future Topic Discussion

Time: 6:11 pm

Committee members indicated policies they would like to consider for revision, including a request to look at the policy covering interdistrict transfer, specifically to consider adding a clause that would allow for the option to reconsider or revoke approvals due to poor attendance.

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned at 6:13 pm by Michelle DePass.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw

Executive Assistant / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools